

The Examiner

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FRONT PAGE

It Takes A Village

Penny Arcade

We warned of spoilers in the Project Hail Mary trailer, but having read the book now - and living in a world where The Martian exists as a book and a film - I understand why they needed to show everything in that trailer. You can't have a situation where people call the movie "The Martian On A Spaceship." Now that I know everything in the book - I'm literate!!! -I would say that they have not, in fact, spoiled the main thing. I can't wait to go see this shit - there's just so much interesting work that had to be done before they could even tell the story.

FEATURES

This Cheap Frother Is My Favorite Way to Mix Protein Powder

Beth Skwarecki · Lifehacker

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Protein shakes can end up chunky or lumpy if you don't mix them right. That's why a shaker bottle does a better job of mixing whey into milk than simply stirring with a spoon. A blender works even better, if you're up for cleaning a blender when you're done. But there is a better option: a handheld frother .

FoodVille MF02 Rechargeable Milk Frother

\$5.96 at Amazon

\$7.99 Save \$2.03

\$5.96 at Amazon

\$7.99 Save \$2.03

To be clear, this is for drinks where you are mixing a powder into a liquid. (If you want ice and fruit in your protein shake—a smoothie, rather than a simple drink—you'll still need a blender. But you knew that.) As far as I can tell, it works with any powder and any liquid. I've tested the frother, and found it gives excellent results with:

Collagen powder and coffee (or tea)

Whey powder and water

Clear whey and water

Hot cocoa and milk

Various supplement powders in, well, anything

Embarrassingly, I didn't think of this on my own. Supplement companies like MUD\WTR and Beam include a handheld frother in their starter packs. In fact, the only reason I own a frother in the first place is that MUD\WTR sent me one with some samples once in hopes I would review the product. (My review: I don't like it .)

How to use a frother to mix your protein powder

First, get yourself a frother. These are simple handheld gadgets that are priced about the same as a shaker bottle, about \$7-10 on the low end, and going up to roughly infinity since these are a Fancy Coffee Accessory. The cheap ones will do fine for our purposes. Get one that is powered by AA batteries or that you charge over USB .

Next, get your liquid ready. The first time you do this, make sure to use an oversized container. The liquid will rise as you turn the frother on. But if you use, say, eight ounces of liquid in a 16-ounce container, you'll avoid a surprise mess.

Add the powder to the liquid, insert the frother, and turn it on. (Unless you're using clear whey , which tends to gum

up the frother; better to insert the frother first and then add the powder.) If you hold the frother in the center of the cup, you'll get a whirlpool effect that sends the liquid up toward (or over) the rim of the container, hence my warning. Once you've done this a few times, you'll figure out how to do it with less mess. Angling the frother and holding it against the side of the cup tends to keep the waves down. You can also pulse the frother a few times instead of having it on continuously, which cuts down on the waves even further.

It only takes five to 10 seconds to mix yourself a smooth, creamy protein shake—or hot cocoa, or whatever else your smooth-beverage-appreciating heart desires. Take a few more seconds to wash the business end of the frother; a brief swish with a soapy sponge under running water is usually all you need. And then enjoy your perfectly mixed drink with nothing besides your cup to clean up later.

Apple's Newest AirPods Pro Are \$50 Off During Amazon's Big Spring Sale

Jake Peterson · Lifehacker

We may earn a commission from links on this page. Deal pricing and availability subject to change after time of publication.

If you're in the Apple ecosystem, and you're looking for a new pair of earbuds, you'd have trouble doing better than AirPods Pro 3. Apple's flagship earbuds sound great, come with interchangeable tips, and sport a number of intelligent, useful features. That package doesn't come cheap, though—Apple has the newest AirPods Pro priced at \$249. That's why they're great to buy on sale: Amazon currently has the AirPods Pro 3 for \$50 off their usual price.

AirPods Pro 3

\$199.00 at Amazon

\$249.00 Save \$50.00

\$199.00 at Amazon

\$249.00 Save \$50.00

AirPods Pro 3 are Apple's best earbuds, hands down—if you prefer the design, that is. They offer the highest quality sound, the best noise cancellation, and sizing flexibility with their interchangeable tips. If you find that the “one size fits all” approach of Apple's standard AirPods don't work for you, one of these AirPods Pro sizes might fit better.

AirPods Pro 3 come with a ton of features, too. The buds have Active Noise Cancellation, and Apple says these are up to four times better than its first-generation Pros. There's also Conversation Awareness, which lowers the volume of your music when you're speaking so you can have a chat, then raises the volume back up when you're done. Apple's Live Translation feature can translate conversations on the fly directly in your AirPods, and you can even use the buds as hearing aids. (They're actually FDA-approved .)

But those features are also in some of Apple's other earbuds. What's exclusive here is the built-in heart rate sensor. If you have an Apple Watch , or another fitness tracker, you might not find that particularly useful, but if you don't, you can rely on your earbuds to keep tabs on your heart rate during exercises, for more accurate fitness measurements. The charging case is also Apple's first to include its second-generation Ultra Wideband chip, which makes finding the case (and your buds) much easier with Find My.

Apple says you can get up to eight hours of listening time on a single charge with Active Noise Cancellation (6.5 hours when using the heart rate sensor), and up to 24 hours when you take the charging case into consideration. These are IP57-rated for resistance against dust, sweat, and water, so while they're not water proof , they should handle workouts just fine.

Our Best Editor-Vetted Amazon Big Spring Sale Deals Right Now

Apple AirPods Pro 3 Noise Cancelling Heart Rate Wireless Earbuds

— \$199.00

(List Price \$249.00)

Apple iPad 11" 128GB A16 WiFi Tablet (Blue, 2025)

— \$299.00

(List Price \$349.00)

Samsung Galaxy Tab A11+ 128GB Wi-Fi 11" Tablet (Gray)

— \$209.99

(List Price \$249.99)

Sony WH1000XM6- Best Wireless Noise Canceling Headphones

— \$398.00

(List Price \$459.99)

Apple Watch Series 11 (GPS, 42mm, S/M Black Sport Band)

— \$299.00

(List Price \$399.00)

Blink Video Doorbell Wireless (Newest Model) + Sync Module Core

— \$35.99

(List Price \$69.99)

Fire TV Stick 4K Max Streaming Player With Remote

— \$34.99

(List Price \$59.99)

Amazon Kindle Colorsoft 16GB 7" eReader (Black)

— \$169.99

(List Price \$249.99)

Deals are selected by our commerce team

My Favorite Mini Massage Gun Is 21% Off for Amazon's Big Spring Sale

Meredith Dietz · Lifehacker

We may earn a commission from links on this page. Deal pricing and availability subject to change after time of publication.

When you're shopping around for a massage gun, you want to focus on features that justify the price. Specifically, I focus on features like speed settings (both intensity and versatility), noise and ease of use, battery life, and size. I've learned the hard way that when you're looking for a travel-sized massage gun, you have to be extra shrewd.

I was once gifted a mini massage gun that, according to the holiday gift exchange rules, must have cost less than \$30. It ran out of battery within one or two minutes of weak "massaging." All of that is to say, a cheap massage gun isn't worth it. Even if you're looking for "mini," you still need to invest in one up to the task of hammering away the pain. And do I have the guy for you: Normally \$99.99, this mini massage gun is currently on sale for \$78.82 as part of Amazon's Big Spring Sale.

Bob and Brad Mini Massage Gun

\$78.82 at Amazon

\$99.99 Save \$21.17

\$78.82 at Amazon

\$99.99 Save \$21.17

At barely one pound, the Bob and Brad Q2 Mini certainly lives up to its name. Luckily, this massage gun still packs a lot of punch, in terms of both literal vibrations and my overall user experience. For me, the real selling point of this massage gun—which I review in-depth here—is the effectiveness of its heat therapy. Plus, its compact size makes it perfect for travel or bringing to the gym—something I never considered with my full-sized TheraGun Therabody. Even if you already own a larger massage gun, the Q2 Mini's heat therapy and sweet size could make it a worthwhile addition to your recovery toolkit.

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Amazon Kindle Colorsoft 16GB 7" eReader (Black)

— \$169.99

(List Price \$249.99)

Deals are selected by our commerce team

99, this mini massage gun is currently on sale for \$78.

Meredith Dietz

The Samsung Galaxy Watch 8 Is \$130 Off for Amazon's Big Spring Sale

Meredith Dietz · Lifehacker

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Fitness watches aren't always known for being polite, but I do know of one that is actually thoughtful and effective when it tells you to take a movement break. Normally \$499.99, the Samsung Galaxy Watch 8 is currently on sale for \$369.99 as part of Amazon's Big Spring Sale .

Samsung Galaxy Watch 8 Classic

\$369.99 at Amazon

\$499.99 Save \$130.00

\$369.99 at Amazon

\$499.99 Save \$130.00

As my colleague Beth Skwarecki shares in her in-depth review , this fitness watch's alerts are customizable and gentle in its nudges. This is huge for anyone who has stress dreams over closing their rings .

Overall, the Galaxy 8 Classic is a well-designed watch that not only looks stylish, but also communicates information in a way that actually makes sense. For instance, heart rate zones come with a note about what they're based on. Similarly, the built-in running coach unlocks two workouts at a time, so that you can do them out of order or skip one guilt-free.

If you're not sure whether to get the regular Galaxy 8 or the Classic, the biggest difference is that the Classic comes with a rotating bezel that helps you navigate the menus. For loyal Samsung users, that rotating bezel makes the Classic a fan favorite.

You can read more about the Galaxy 8 Watch in CNET's review , too.

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(List Price \$249.00)

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Deals are selected by our commerce team

What's New on Netflix in April 2026

Emily Long · Lifehacker

Netflix's April lineup is packed with something for everyone. There are new installments of reality series *Million Dollar Secret* (April 15), Netflix's answer to NBC's *The Traitors*, and *Temptation Island* (April 10). Comedy series *Running Point* (April 23) also returns for a second season, with Kate Hudson starring as the president of her family's pro basketball franchise.

Big Mistakes (April 9) is a new crime comedy series created by Dan Levy, who stars alongside Taylor Ortega as one of a pair of siblings who get blackmailed into participating in organized crime. And Kevin Hart has a new comedy competition series: *Funny AF with Kevin Hart* (April 20) incorporates real-time audience voting to find the next stand-up comedy star.

The new film *Apex* (April 24) is an action thriller starring Charlize Theron as a grieving woman in the Australian wilderness being hunted down by Taron Egerton. Finally, the April documentary slate is long: there's *This is a Gardening Show* (April 22), narrated by Zach Galifianakis, and *A Gorilla Story: Told by David Attenborough* (April 17), as well as the musical docs *Noah Kahan: Out of Body* (April 13) and *Lainey Wilson: Keepin' Country Cool* (April 22). *Trust Me: The False Prophet* (April 8) is a true crime series that looks at Warren Jeffs's FLDS sect in Utah. Netflix is also dropping a handful of episodes of its *Untold* sports docuseries.

Here's everything else coming to Netflix in April, and everything that's leaving.

What's coming to Netflix in April 2026

Available soon

If Wishes Could Kill —Netflix Series

Available April 1

Eat Pray Bark —Netflix Film

The Giant Falls —Netflix Film

It Takes a Village —Netflix Film

Love on the Spectrum: Season 4 —Netflix Series

Sarah Millican: Late Bloomer —Netflix Comedy Special

The Age of Adaline

Happy's Place: Season 1

Hotel Transylvania 2

Madagascar 3: Europe's Most Wanted

Madagascar: Escape 2 Africa

Mission: Impossible

Mission: Impossible - Ghost Protocol

Mission: Impossible - Rogue Nation

Mission: Impossible II

Mission: Impossible III

Penguins of Madagascar: The Movie

Smokey and the Bandit

Smokey and the Bandit II

St. Denis Medical: Season 1

Available April 2

Agent from Above —Netflix Series

Alkhallat+: The Series: Desert Rules —Netflix Series

The Bad Guys: The Series: Season 2 —Netflix Family

The Ramparts of Ice —Netflix Series

Sins of Kujo —Netflix Series

XO, Kitty: Season 3 —Netflix Series

Available April 3

Bloodhounds: Season 2 —Netflix Series

Feel My Voice —Netflix Film

Gangs of Galicia: Season 2 —Netflix Series

High Tides: Season 3 —Netflix Series

Maamla Legal Hai: Season 2 —Netflix Series

The Truth and Tragedy of Moriah Wilson —Netflix Documentary

Available April 7

Beast (2022)

Sheng Wang: Purple —Netflix Comedy Special

Untold: Chess Mates —Netflix Documentary

Available April 8

Trust Me: The False Prophet —Netflix Documentary

Available April 9

18th Rose

The Apple Watch Ultra 2 Is Nearly \$200 Off for the Amazon Big Spring Sale

Jake Peterson · Lifehacker

We may earn a commission from links on this page. Deal pricing and availability subject to change after time of publication.

If you're looking for an Apple Watch for extreme sports, or you just want the one with the biggest display and battery life, you should focus your sights on the Ultra. Apple packs as many features and perks into this watch as it can, and, as such, it's the best option for people who need to push their wearables to the max. But those advantages come at a cost: The latest Apple Watch Ultra 3 costs \$799, making it one of the most expensive watch options the company sells.

But you don't need to spend as much on an Apple Watch Ultra as an iPhone 17 in order to get many of these perks. If you're willing to move one generation early, and lose a few new features, you can save some serious money, especially during discounts and sales. As it happens, this "Premium Renewed" Apple Watch Ultra 2 is currently \$399.49 on Amazon during its Big Spring Sale. That's its cheapest price on the site in at least the past three months, according to Keepa.

Apple Watch Ultra 2

\$399.49 at Amazon

\$589.00 Save \$189.51

\$399.49 at Amazon

\$589.00 Save \$189.51

The features list of the Apple Watch Ultra 2 are quite long. Off the bat, you get a 49mm display that can reach a whopping 3,000 nits of brightness. The heart rate monitor can look out for signs of hypertension, alert you when your heart rate is too high or too low, and let you know when you have an irregular heart rhythm. You can also use the Blood Oxygen app to monitor your SpO2 levels.

Like all Apple Watches, the Ultra 2 can track your sleep, including giving you a sleep score each night, but it can also let you know if you show signs of sleep apnea. It'll track your vitals, body temperature, cycles (if applicable), and can connect to cellular if you pay for a plan. This watch comes with Apple's S9 chip, the same as you'll find in the Series 9 line, and supports Apple's double-tap gesture, as well as Precision Finding, in case your watch goes missing.

But since this is the Ultra 2, there are some nontraditional features here, like water resistance up to 100 meters, and support for snorkeling, scubaing, and high-speed water sports. There's a depth gauge up to 40m if you do any diving, and the watch even comes with a siren in case you need others to know where you are. This isn't an exhaustive list of features, so check out the listing for the full rundown.

The caveat for this particular sale, however, is that this is a "Premium Renewed" product. According to Amazon, all "Renewed" products are fully functional, and come with original or generic accessories. To be "Premium," the renewed product must not have any cosmetic damage visible from 12 inches away, no scratches on the screen, and a battery capacity 90% or higher. I wouldn't be surprised if these Apple Watch Ultra 2 models were simply open box, rather than previously used, but before you invest, know that there is a chance someone else used this watch.

If you're curious about the latest model, the Ultra 3, here's what you get if you spring for the extra cost: a slightly larger, higher-quality OLED display with LTPO3 (versus LTPO2 on the Ultra 2); Emergency SOS via satellite; 5G connectivity (if you spring for the cellular plan); the S10 chip; battery life that lasts 42 hours, versus 36 hours on the Ultra 2; and 12 hours of use with 15 minutes of charging. Both the Ultra 2 and Ultra 3 support fast charging up to 80%, but the Ultra 3 can do it in 45 minutes, while the Ultra 2 takes about an hour. Those advantages might be worth the added cost, depending on your needs.

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— \$199.00

(List Price \$249.00)

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Samsung Galaxy Tab A11+ 128GB Wi-Fi 11" Tablet (Gray)

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Blink Video Doorbell Wireless (Newest Model) + Sync Module Core

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But since this is the Ultra 2, there are some nontraditional features here, like water resistance up to 100 meters, and support for snorkeling, scubaing, and high-speed water sports.

Jake Peterson

The Best Tech Deals Under \$25 During Amazon's Big Spring Sale

Daniel Oropesa · Lifehacker

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Amazon's Big Spring Sale is on its third day, and there are tons of big-ticket items still on sale. But if you're looking to score a bargain on a budget, I've used all my resources to find the best tech deals under \$25.

Roku Streaming Stick HD

\$17.99 at Amazon

\$29.99 Save \$12.00

\$17.99 at Amazon

\$29.99 Save \$12.00

Fire TV Stick 4K Plus Streaming Player With Remote (2025 Model)

\$24.99 at Amazon

\$49.99 Save \$25.00

\$24.99 at Amazon

\$49.99 Save \$25.00

\$19.98 at Amazon

\$39.99 Save \$20.01

\$19.98 at Amazon

\$39.99 Save \$20.01

INIU 10000mAh 45W Power Bank with USB-C Cable

\$11.21 at Amazon

\$29.99 Save \$18.78

\$11.21 at Amazon

\$29.99 Save \$18.78

CooSpo Fitness Tracker Ant+ Heart Rate Monitor

\$26.99 at Amazon

\$29.99 Save \$3.00

\$26.99 at Amazon

\$29.99 Save \$3.00

SEE 2 MORE

The Roku Streaming Stick HD is \$18

The Roku Streaming Stick HD is the most basic Roku Stick you can buy, and it's 40% off right now, making it a great time to upgrade your TV's OS to my favorite one. You can get it for \$17.99 (originally \$29.99).

Fire TV Sticks are now \$25

Amazon's Fire TV Stick 4K Plus is one of Amazon's most popular Fire TV Stick options. It's powerful enough for 4K entertainment, and it's just \$25 for the Amazon Big Spring Sale (down from \$49.99) after a 50% discount. The Fire TV Stick Plus sits above the base Fire TV Stick HD (also discounted right now), and offers a quad-core 1.7 GHz processor coupled with 2GB RAM for fast app launches and smooth navigation.

Anker wired earbuds are \$20

If you are looking for earbuds but don't want to pay too much for something you might end up losing, the Soundcore by Anker P20i are a solid pair with some impressive features for their \$19.99 price (marked down from \$39.99). You get Bluetooth 5.3, 30 hours of battery, water resistance, and a full EQ with its companion app.

This Iniu portable phone charger is \$21

I recently lost my Iniu portable charger on a weekend road trip. Fortunately, it was at the end of my trip, and it had served its purpose well, saving my phone's battery (and therefore my life) multiple times. You can get one now for \$20.99 (originally \$29.99).

A heart rate monitor you can trust for just a little over \$25

Okay, yes, I cheated a bit. This one is \$27, but trust me when I say those extra \$2 will be well spent. The CooSpo chest strap is a specialist. It has one job, which is to measure your heart rate, and it does it so well, Lifehacker's Senior Health Editor Beth Skwarecki uses it to get a baseline when she tests other fitness gadgets. If monitoring your heart is a priority, don't sleep on this chest strap.

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Samsung Galaxy Tab A11+ 128GB Wi-Fi 11" Tablet (Gray)

The Examiner — 2026-03-30
— \$209.99

10 Shows Like ‘The Comeback’ You Should Watch Next

Ross Johnson · Lifehacker

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Valerie Cherish is back, and not a moment too soon. Twenty years after a modestly rated but absolutely brilliant first season, mega-*cringe* Hollywood satire *The Comeback* has returned to HBO for one more painfully embarrassing season (complimentary) Co-created by and starring Lisa Kudrow, it's the hilarious, dark, and occasionally moving story of a C-list celebrity determined to stay in the limelight at whatever cost.

Valerie Cherish—clueless, egotistical, and all-too-human—is one of TV's indelible characters, simultaneously a victim of ageism, misogyny, and celebrity culture, and also a woman who doesn't care about any of that provided she can find a way to scrabble to the top. Likewise, these 10 shows spotlight women (mostly) of a certain age navigating career challenges with...mixed results.

Hacks (2021 –)

On the surface, Valerie Cherish and Deborah Vance don't have all that much in common, but they often feel like two sides of a coin in the ways in which they battle, and concede to, the pressures of being a woman in modern show business. *Hacks* finds 25-year-old writer Ava (Hannah Einbinder) struggling to get her career back on track after getting cancelled over a tweet. She reluctantly takes a job with Deborah Vance (Jean Smart), a comedy trailblazer who remains popular with an older Vegas crown, but whose career is largely on autopilot. They're an entirely mismatched pair, but their chemistry is ultimately explosive, with Jean Smart doing some of the best work of her incredible career as the often deeply unlikeable Vance, and Einbinder more than holding her own in return. It's funny, bitchy, and surprisingly moving when it wants to be. Stream *Hacks* on HBO Max .

Hacks (2021 –)

Girls5Eva (2021 – 2024)

The premise is very much about a comeback: A very '90s group (Sara Bareilles, Busy Philipps, Paula Pell, and Renée Elise Goldsberry) who made it big very briefly with exactly one hit song gets its own shot at a career resurgence (they're Girls5Eva because they expected to be in the game “longer than 4 ever”—turned out, not so much; also there used to be a fifth member, but she died in a tragic infinity pool accident). After an up-and-coming rapper samples one of their old hits, the band reunites to try to find new relevancy in the 2020s. It doesn't go great! Tina Fey is one of the executive producers, and the (very fun) '90s-inspired original music was composed and written for the show by the creators. Stream Girls5Eva on Peacock and Netflix .

Girls5Eva (2021 – 2024)

at Peacock

at Peacock

Veep (2012 – 2019)

There's a sweet vulnerability to Valerie Cherish absent from pretty much anyone in *Veep* , but the air of cringeworthy desperation hangs heavy over both shows. *Veep* asks: What if the very worst people imaginable had control of all the levers of power in America? What would that be like? In the highly satirical and in no way politically relevant series, Julia Louis-Dreyfus brilliantly plays Vice President Selina Meyer: part icon, part worst-case-scenario for the feminist dream. The supporting cast consists almost entirely of entitled rich people climbing over each other for infinitesimal extra bits of power while trying to appear as folk heroes to the rubes (us voters). It's one of the funniest shows ever on TV, with the nastiest put-downs...if you can handle the fact that history has overtaken it in favor of a reality that's even more absurd. Stream *Veep* on HBO Max.

Veep (2012 – 2019)

at HBO Max

at HBO Max

The Studio (2025 –)

Industry exec Matt Remick (*Comeback* vet Seth Rogen) loves movies, and when he signs on for a high-profile role at the fictional Continental Studios, he feels like his time has come. He aims to make a real difference in returning an increasingly IP-driven movie industry to its creative roots. —until about a minute into his new job, when the CEO (Bryan Cranston) reveals his first order of business will be marketing the *Kool-Aid Man Movie* . Hollywood satires of yore have focused on the industry as one that eats people up and spits them out, but the spin here is that Remick yearns for those good old days, much as Valerie can never quite seem to move forward. The late Catherine O'Hara, Ike Barinholtz, Chase Sui Wonders (*Bodies Bodies Bodies*), and Kathryn Hahn also star, and like *The Comeback* , the show boasts a long list of celebrity cameos. Stream *The Studio* on Apple TV+ .

The Studio (2025 –)

at Apple TV+

at Apple TV+

Enlightened (2011 – 2013)

Before *The White Lotus* , Mike White co-created (with star Laura Dern) this beloved, if short-lived, comedy-drama about a middle-aged woman who has a complete mental breakdown following a demotion at the job to which she's devoted her life. Following a two-month stay in an holistic treatment facility, Dern's Amy Jellicoe becomes determined to approach life with a new perspective, focusing on medi-

Everything You're Entitled to When Your Flight Gets Delayed or Canceled

Meredith Dietz · Lifehacker

In recent days, travelers have faced the highest wait times in TSA history, “with some wait times greater than 4.5 hours,” said the agency’s acting chief, Ha Nguyen McNeill, in a testimony before the House Committee on Homeland Security on March 25.

Unlike weather delays that clear up on their own, this madness could continue as long as the partial government shutdown does. Airlines are bracing themselves for more record-breaking security lines, which means more chaos and more uncertainty. You want to be prepared to fight for what you’re entitled to when an airline, for lack of a better phrase, utterly screws you over. Here’s how to always get the most money possible from a canceled or delayed flight.

Know your airline passenger rights

Federal law still does not require airlines to provide passengers with money or other compensation when flights are delayed. This means that in most cases, compensation is at the discretion of the airline.

Canceled flights

If an airline cancels your flight less than 14 days before departure and you choose to cancel your trip entirely, you’re entitled to a refund of both your plane ticket and any pre-paid baggage fees. This typically applies even if you have non-refundable tickets.

Delayed flights

Again, federal law does not require airlines to provide passengers with any sort of reimbursement when flights are delayed. When flights are delayed for unpredictable events like weather or mechanical issues, compensation is at the discretion of the airline. However, the airline is required to rebook you on a different flight at no additional cost. And if you end up stuck in the airport, it’s up to the airline to decide what sort of vouchers they offer—more on that below.

Baggage issues

Few things are as frustrating as finally making it to your destination, only for your luggage to be lost somewhere between your departure and your arrival. Airlines are required to compensate you for any “reasonable, verifiable, and actual” expenses that arise due to your baggage damage or delay, according to the DOT.

Unfortunately, you may not be fully compensated for everything that’s lost or damaged in your bag. There is also a cap on the amount of money airlines are required to compensate you if your bags are lost, damaged, or delayed. The maximum liability amount allowed by the DOT is \$4,700 per passenger. You should immediately notify your airline if your bag has been damaged and ensure the conversation

is documented so you can file a claim with the DOT if you are not properly compensated.

And if your bag is delayed, it’s the airline’s responsibility to find and get it back to you. While most airlines promise to bring your bag to your hotel or wherever you’re staying once it’s found, this is not a requirement nor a guarantee.

Overbooking and denied boarding

Somehow, overbooking flights is not only legal, but commonplace. When an airline overbooks a flight, it can either voluntarily or involuntarily bump passengers. Before bumping passengers involuntarily or without approval, airlines must seek out voluntary travelers willing to take another flight in exchange for compensation. You’ve probably heard airlines incentivize travelers with vouchers. However, if no one takes the customer service reps up on these voucher offers, the airline may involuntarily bump passengers or deny boarding. This turns into “denied boarding.”

Depending on the airline’s reasoning, you may be eligible for compensation if you are denied boarding. If you are bumped from a flight due to reasons such as overbooking, you may qualify for denied boarding compensation. However, passengers are usually not eligible for compensation if they experience any of the following situations:

Aircraft changes due to safety or operational reasons

A plane’s weight or balance restrictions prevent the passenger from boarding

A passenger is downgraded to a lower seating class for an overbooked flight

Charter flights that run outside an airline’s regular schedule are overbooked, delayed, or canceled

Flights on small aircrafts (less than 30 passengers) are overbooked, delayed, or canceled

International flights are overbooked, delayed, or canceled

To qualify for involuntary denied boarding compensation, you must have a confirmed flight reservation, you must have checked in and arrived at your gate on time, and you must be unable to reach your destination within one hour of your original flight’s arrival time. The compensation amount will depend on how long of a delay you face, which is outlined on the DOT website.

What exactly are you entitled to if your flight is delayed?

According to DOT, you are entitled to a refund if the airline cancels a flight, regardless of the reason, and you choose not to travel or accept travel credits, vouchers, or other forms of compensation offered by the airline.

But while airlines are required to give passengers refunds if their flights are outright canceled, the rules around delays are less clear. For instance, “significant delay” is not offi-

This Best-Pick 65-Inch Hisense QLED TV Is Over 50% Off Right Now

Pradershika Sharma · Lifehacker

Deal pricing and availability subject to change after time of publication.

Hisense's mid-range TVs tend to land in that sweet spot of good features at a not-astronomical price. That certainly describes the 2025 U7 Series right now, as the 65-inch model is discounted by \$800 at Best Buy, dropping to just \$699. It's one of Lifehacker's picks for the best 65-inch TVs in 2026, especially at this price.

The sale price is good through April 19, and Best Buy is sweetening the deal with a discount on mounting and free haul-away for members, making upgrading your older TV a bit less of a chore.

65-inch Hisense 65U75QG TV

MiniLED Smart 4K TV (2025)

\$699.00 at Best Buy

\$1,499.00 Save \$800.00

\$699.00 at Best Buy

\$1,499.00 Save \$800.00

The Mini-LED backlighting and QLED panel of the 65U75QG deliver deep blacks with minimal blooming, and displays punchy HDR content with support for Dolby Vision and HDR10+, so watching movies or sports feels lively. It gets bright enough to handle sunlit rooms without looking washed out, though if your room has a lot of light, reflections can show up during darker scenes. There's a built-in speaker setup with a subwoofer and upward-firing speakers, which adds some height to the soundstage, though it won't replace a dedicated soundbar. As Google TV runs the interface, apps, casting, and voice control are all baked in.

On the downside, this TV doesn't track brightness levels as precisely as higher-end models, so scenes can look slightly off without calibration. Also, the viewing angle is narrow enough that colors and contrast shift if you're sitting too far to the side. While gaming works well overall, with smooth performance and plenty of support for high refresh rates, fast-moving scenes may blur more than expected. None of these factors will be a dealbreaker for casual use, but they matter if you're picky about image accuracy or plan to use this in a wide seating setup. For most people, though, this is a bright, capable TV that covers a lot of ground, especially for this price.

Our Best Editor-Vetted Amazon Big Spring Sale Deals Right Now

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— \$199.00

(List Price \$249.00)

Apple iPad 11" 128GB A16 WiFi Tablet (Blue, 2025)

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(List Price \$59.99)

Amazon Kindle Colorsoft 16GB 7" eReader (Black)

— \$169.99

(List Price \$249.99)

Deals are selected by our commerce team

10 Hacks Every ChatGPT User Should Know

David Nield · Lifehacker

If you're a regular ChatGPT user, then you're one of a crowd that's now around 900 million people strong. It seems that plenty of us are spending significant amounts of time with the AI chatbot, whether that's to get more done, search the web, work on creative or coding projects, or just have something to talk to. Are you making the most out of ChatGPT though? The web, mobile, and desktop apps come with a selection of settings and some prompt adjustment possibilities that you may not have fully explored yet. Here's how to level up.

Use 'branch conversations' to explore tangents off your chats

OpenAI often rolls out minor but useful upgrades to ChatGPT that can get missed, and one of those is branch conversations. They quite literally let you branch off from one conversation and start another, while leaving the original chat preserved so you can go back to it if you need to (and maybe start another branch). It's a simple way to go off on a tangent with a discussion. Click or tap the three dots at the end of any ChatGPT response and you'll see the Branch in new chat option. A new chat is then created, based on the first.

Trick ChatGPT into returning shorter, more effective results

You can specify what kind of target audience you are to ChatGPT. Credit: Lifehacker

The internet is awash with ChatGPT prompt "hacks" of varying quality and effectiveness, and they all really boil down to the specificity of the instructions you're giving the AI. From the length of the responses to the data format they're outputted in, tell ChatGPT what you want in precise terms, and it will oblige.

One of the best of these prompt hacks I've seen lately is from u/AdCold1610 on Reddit, and all you have to do is put "extremely lazy person here" somewhere in the prompt. It often has quite a profound effect on the response: Answers get shorter and to the point, and if there are instructions involved they become simpler and more straightforward. You get less fluff and more action in general, though obviously how much impact the lazy prompt has will vary on what you're asking of the AI.

Use Voice Mode to record memos or thoughts

You may well have seen the little sound wave icon down in the bottom right corner of the ChatGPT prompt box and given Voice Mode a try, without really knowing how to make use of it or why it works better than typing in your prompts. One potentially helpful idea, though, is to use it as a voice memo recorder for stuff you need to get done; another is to use it as an audio-based personal journal for thoughts and reflections. You can keep them all together in one chat, or spread them out.

There's no shortage of mobile apps that will record audio clips for you, but they don't come with ChatGPT's AI analysis brain attached. Once you've built up a library of recordings, you can get it to prioritize your to do list, remind you about something you've forgotten, summarize the main themes of your reflections, sum up your mood changes over the week, or whatever else you can think of.

Use "Personalization" to tailor ChatGPT's answers towards your interests

Delve into the Personalization settings. Credit: Lifehacker

You can tailor the answers ChatGPT gives you by telling it more about yourself: what you know about a certain topic, how you best absorb information, how verbose or succinct you'd like the AI's responses to be, and so on. But entering these details for each and every prompt can get tiresome quickly.

There's actually a place to put details like this in ChatGPT's settings, as long as you open the panel on the web or desktop: Click your account profile avatar (bottom left), then choose Personalization. The next screen not only lets you set some guidelines for the personality ChatGPT should use by default, it also lets you tell the AI a bit about yourself—which it will keep permanently in its memory. You can add details including your occupation, your ethical values, your preferred learning style, and your main interests.

Use Photoshop to edit photos within ChatGPT for free

ChatGPT comes with mini-apps you can connect to via the prompt box, and one of those apps happens to be Photoshop—meaning you can carry out some pretty advanced edits using Adobe's software technology, free of charge.

The plug-in is currently available in all the ChatGPT apps except Android and Windows. Pick Apps from the navigation pane, then search for "Photoshop" and click Connect to add it to your ChatGPT tools. You can then call it into action via the + (plus) button in the prompt box, or by typing "@" in your prompt followed by the app name.

With Photoshop enabled, you can perform all kinds of edits: blur backgrounds, remove objects, and tweak brightness and contrast, for example. Just use the same natural language as you would in any ChatGPT conversation. You do need to upload an image to edit, or provide a public web link to one. If you don't do this before you submit your prompt, you'll be asked to do it after.

Use your phone camera for live help

Don't neglect the Camera option on mobile. Credit: Lifehacker

ChatGPT for Android and iOS comes with a superpower: access to your phone's camera, so you can feed it photos in real time as you explore the world and go about the business of daily life. Just tap the + (plus) button by the prompt box,

Please Don't Feed the Scattered Lapsus ShinyHunters

Brian Krebs · Krebs on Security

A prolific data ransom gang that calls itself Scattered Lapsus ShinyHunters (SLSH) has a distinctive playbook when it seeks to extort payment from victim firms: Harassing, threatening and even swatting executives and their families, all while notifying journalists and regulators about the extent of the intrusion. Some victims reportedly are paying — perhaps as much to contain the stolen data as to stop the escalating personal attacks. But a top SLSH expert warns that engaging at all beyond a “We’re not paying” response only encourages further harassment, noting that the group’s fractious and unreliable history means the only winning move is not to pay.

Image: Shutterstock.com, @Mungujakisa

Unlike traditional, highly regimented Russia-based ransomware affiliate groups, SLSH is an unruly and somewhat fluid English-language extortion gang that appears uninterested in building a reputation of consistent behavior whereby victims might have some measure of confidence that the criminals will keep their word if paid.

That’s according to Allison Nixon, director of research at the New York City based security consultancy Unit 221B. Nixon has been closely tracking the criminal group and individual members as they bounce between various Telegram channels used to extort and harass victims, and she said SLSH differs from traditional data ransom groups in other important ways that argue against trusting them to do anything they say they’ll do — such as destroying stolen data.

Like SLSH, many traditional Russian ransomware groups have employed high-pressure tactics to force payment in exchange for a decryption key and/or a promise to delete stolen data, such as publishing a dark web shaming blog with samples of stolen data next to a countdown clock, or notifying journalists and board members of the victim company. But Nixon said the extortion from SLSH quickly escalates way beyond that — to threats of physical violence against executives and their families, DDoS attacks on the victim’s website, and repeated email-flooding campaigns.

SLSH is known for breaking into companies by phishing employees over the phone, and using the purloined access to steal sensitive internal data. In a January 30 blog post, Google’s security forensics firm Mandiant said SLSH’s most recent extortion attacks stem from incidents spanning early to mid-January 2026, when SLSH members pretended to be IT staff and called employees at targeted victim organizations claiming that the company was updating MFA settings.

“The threat actor directed the employees to victim-branded credential harvesting sites to capture their SSO credentials and MFA codes, and then registered their own device for MFA,” the blog post explained.

Victims often first learn of the breach when their brand name is uttered on whatever ephemeral new public Telegram group chat SLSH is using to threaten, extort and harass their prey. According to Nixon, the coordinated harassment on the SLSH Telegram channels is part of a well-orchestrated strategy to overwhelm the victim organization by manufacturing humiliation that pushes them over the threshold to pay.

Nixon said multiple executives at targeted organizations have been subject to “swatting” attacks, wherein SLSH communicated a phony bomb threat or hostage situation at the target’s address in the hopes of eliciting a heavily armed police response at their home or place of work.

“A big part of what they’re doing to victims is the psychological aspect of it, like harassing executives’ kids and threatening the board of the company,” Nixon told KrebsOnSecurity. “And while these victims are getting extortion demands, they’re simultaneously getting outreach from media outlets saying, ‘Hey, do you have any comments on the bad things we’re going to write about you.’”

In a blog post today, Unit 221B argues that no one should negotiate with SLSH because the group has demonstrated a willingness to extort victims based on promises that it has no intention to keep. Nixon points out that all of SLSH’s known members hail from The Com, shorthand for a constellation of cybercrime-focused Discord and Telegram communities which serve as a kind of distributed social network that facilitates instant collaboration.

Nixon said Com-based extortion groups tend to instigate feuds and drama between group members, leading to lying, betrayals, credibility destroying behavior, backstabbing, and sabotaging each other.

“With this type of ongoing dysfunction, often compounding by substance abuse, these threat actors often aren’t able to act with the core goal in mind of completing a successful, strategic ransom operation,” Nixon wrote. “They continually lose control with outbursts that put their strategy and operational security at risk, which severely limits their ability to build a professional, scalable, and sophisticated criminal organization network for continued successful ransoms — unlike other, more tenured and professional criminal organizations focused on ransomware alone.”

Intrusions from established ransomware groups typically center around encryption/decryption malware that mostly stays on the affected machine. In contrast, Nixon said, ransom from a Com group is often structured the same as violent sextortion schemes against minors, wherein members of The Com will steal damaging information, threaten to release it, and “promise” to delete it if the victim complies without any guarantee or technical proof point that they will keep their word. She writes:

A key component of SLSH’s efforts to convince victims to pay, Nixon said, involves manipulating the media into hyping the threat posed by this group. This approach also

The Best Ways to Make Use of Those Spare USB Ports on Your TV or Monitor

David Nield · Lifehacker

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If you've taken a look at the back of your computer monitor or TV lately, you may have noticed there's a USB port or two alongside the more familiar HDMI—and that in turn might have left you wondering what exactly a USB port is doing on the back of a big screen. Well, these USB ports have more uses than you might think.

Their precise function is going to depend on the make and model of your TV and monitor—and the primary uses tend to differ between the two. However, we can talk generally about how to make use of these ports and some of the options available to you, so you can check on your own specific device to see what's supported.

The extra ports can charge your devices

This is a big one, because it applies to just about every USB port on every TV and monitor: You can plug in small gadgets like phones and charge them up, though charging rates and supported devices may vary, especially on televisions. It saves you having to hunt around for a spare wall outlet, at least.

On higher-end monitors with support for USB Power Delivery (USB-PD), you can sometimes charge up larger devices like laptops, while also providing a video connection through the same USB-C cable. It's something to look out for if you're shopping around, as it helps reduce desk clutter and adds convenience—the \$620 4K Dell U2725QE is one example of a monitor that will do this for you.

With Android smartphones and monitors, you might get the added bonus of support for a desktop environment on the big screen as well as device charging. Both Samsung DeX and the recently launched Pixel Desktop Mode can be used like this, so you might be able to attach a desktop or laptop via HDMI, and a phone via USB-C.

Set up a USB hub for cleaner cable maintenance

As well as device charging, some monitors also add USB hub functionality, especially at the higher end of the market—if you've got several USB-A ports on the back of your monitor, this is likely what they're for.

Rather than plugging all your peripherals into your laptop or desktop computer, you can add them to your monitor instead. It's a solution that's often neater and removes the need for a separate USB hub on your desk—with a separate upstream USB cable handling the connection to your computer, if it's not attached via a single data and video cable.

You might even see an Ethernet port on some models, giving you a high-speed wired connection to the internet for your laptop. The \$260 1080p ViewSonic VG2456 is one such model, and they often offer great value for office use.

Connect external storage to display photos and videos

This is a primary one for TVs, including certain Samsung models: You can plug an external USB drive into the back of your television, and access the photos, videos, or audio on it, provided the drive and file formats are supported. You can also do this via the USB ports on monitors, via the USB hub functionality mentioned above.

If you've got a large local media library saved somewhere, then this is a simple and quick way of getting those media files up on the big screen (rather than using something like Plex). You're most likely not going to get the most advanced user interface you've ever seen, but it'll work.

With the rise of streaming and faster wifi connections, the functionality is now becoming less common, but it's still around—consult your TV documentation for details (Sony's instructions are here). A portable drive such as the \$90 WD Elements should be suitable, but be careful to check the requirements listed by your TV manufacturer.

Set up a KVM switch for multiple devices

A variation on the USB hub idea is a KVM (Keyboard, Video, Mouse) switch, which can be incredibly useful if you have more than one computer connected up to your monitor (maybe a laptop and a desktop). You can plug your keyboard and mouse into the USB ports on the display, and then use them to control each computer in turn.

You can buy these KVM switches separately, but having one built into your monitor cuts down on the number of trailing cables you have to deal with. Once your peripherals are connected, you can typically switch via the monitor's on-screen menu, or through a dedicated hardware button.

Perhaps you've had this functionality on your monitor and never realized. A good example of this type of display is the \$800 4K Gigabyte M32U aimed at gamers, which does have an integrated button specifically for switching between computers (plus a load of other high-end features, as you would expect at that price).

The Gigabyte M32U has an integrated KVM switch. Credit: Gigabyte

Those extra ports support a bunch of other devices, too

Just about anything that can be powered by USB can be plugged into one of the spare ports on your TV or monitor (if the power demands and supply match). Maybe you could add a desk fan for keeping you cool through the summer months, or maybe you want to get creative with a smart light setup.

For monitors with USB hub functionality, you can think about options like microphones, webcams, and gaming controllers—which can all be easier to plug into a big display rather than a laptop (if your laptop even has any spare USB ports left).

*Rather than plugging all your peripherals into your laptop or desktop computer,
you can add them to your monitor instead.*

David Nield

This Kindle Colorsoft (With Case) Is 40% Off During Amazon’s Big Spring Sale

Daniel Oropeza · Lifehacker

We may earn a commission from links on this page. Deal pricing and availability subject to change after time of publication.

I’ve loved Kindle e-readers since the first Kindle Paperwhite came out in 2012, but until recently, my dream of reading color comics on a Kindle was just that. But then, the Kindle Colorsoft finally came out last summer, and it’s now on sale for \$169.99 (originally \$249.99) during Amazon’s Big Spring Sale . And if you can spare just another \$2, you can get the bundle with the clear case , currently going for \$171.98 (originally \$286.98). This is the biggest discount this device has received since its release, according to price-tracking tools .

You can also get it with three months of free Kindle Unlimited (it’ll auto-renew unless you cancel it), and if you’re a Prime Member, you can fill it up with some free e-books . And here are all the best deals on Kindles during the sale .

Kindle Colorsoft 16GB eReader (2025 Release, No Ads, Metallic Black)

\$169.99 at Amazon

\$249.99 Save \$80.00

\$169.99 at Amazon

\$249.99 Save \$80.00

Amazon Kindle Colorsoft 16GB eReader + Black & Clear Case Bundle

\$171.98 at Amazon

\$286.98 Save \$115.00

\$171.98 at Amazon

\$286.98 Save \$115.00

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The Kindle Colorsoft Signature Edition is exactly what it sounds like: It’s a Kindle e-reader with color. It’s essentially the same hardware and design as the Kindle Paperwhite, with the same dimensions, weight, and 16GB of storage. It also has the same features, like the adjustable warm light, the IPX8 waterproof rating, and the ad-free lock screen that either shows the cover for the book you’re reading, or a generic wallpaper. The battery life is shorter than the Paperwhite’s, with Amazon suggesting it can last up to eight weeks compared to 12 for the Paperwhite, but that’s still plenty for most people. That said, the tech that enables its color display may cause black and white content (like regular books) to look worse, according to our review .

Therefore, unless you’re a dedicated comics reader, the Colorsoft may not be the best option for you.

The seven-inch Kaleido 3 display offers the industry standard 300 pixels per inch (ppi) for black-and-white content and 150ppi for color, but it employs a unique, Amazon-developed stack that improves the color quality. If you love reading comics, this is where the Colorsoft Signature Edition shines: Colors look like a printed newspaper, and there’s a feature that provides a close-up of each comic panel so you can enjoy the art without having to manually zoom into each panel.

Our Best Editor-Vetted Amazon Big Spring Sale Deals Right Now

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(List Price \$249.00)

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— \$169.99

(List Price \$249.99)

How AI Assistants are Moving the Security Goalposts

Brian Krebs · Krebs on Security

AI-based assistants or “agents” — autonomous programs that have access to the user’s computer, files, online services and can automate virtually any task — are growing in popularity with developers and IT workers. But as so many eyebrow-raising headlines over the past few weeks have shown, these powerful and assertive new tools are rapidly shifting the security priorities for organizations, while blurring the lines between data and code, trusted co-worker and insider threat, ninja hacker and novice code jockey.

The new hotness in AI-based assistants — OpenClaw (formerly known as ClawdBot and Moltbot) — has seen rapid adoption since its release in November 2025. OpenClaw is an open-source autonomous AI agent designed to run locally on your computer and proactively take actions on your behalf without needing to be prompted.

The OpenClaw logo.

If that sounds like a risky proposition or a dare, consider that OpenClaw is most useful when it has complete access to your digital life, where it can then manage your inbox and calendar, execute programs and tools, browse the Internet for information, and integrate with chat apps like Discord, Signal, Teams or WhatsApp.

Other more established AI assistants like Anthropic’s Claude and Microsoft’s Copilot also can do these things, but OpenClaw isn’t just a passive digital butler waiting for commands. Rather, it’s designed to take the initiative on your behalf based on what it knows about your life and its understanding of what you want done.

“The testimonials are remarkable,” the AI security firm Snyk observed. “Developers building websites from their phones while putting babies to sleep; users running entire companies through a lobster-themed AI; engineers who’ve set up autonomous code loops that fix tests, capture errors through webhooks, and open pull requests, all while they’re away from their desks.”

You can probably already see how this experimental technology could go sideways in a hurry. In late February, Summer Yue, the director of safety and alignment at Meta’s “superintelligence” lab, recounted on Twitter/X how she was fiddling with OpenClaw when the AI assistant suddenly began mass-deleting messages in her email inbox. The thread included screenshots of Yue frantically pleading with the preoccupied bot via instant message and ordering it to stop.

“Nothing humbles you like telling your OpenClaw ‘confirm before acting’ and watching it speedrun deleting your inbox,” Yue said. “I couldn’t stop it from my phone. I had to RUN to my Mac mini like I was defusing a bomb.”

Meta’s director of AI safety, recounting on Twitter/X how her OpenClaw installation suddenly began mass-deleting her inbox.

There’s nothing wrong with feeling a little *schadenfreude* at Yue’s encounter with OpenClaw, which fits Meta’s “move fast and break things” model but hardly inspires confidence in the road ahead. However, the risk that poorly-secured AI assistants pose to organizations is no laughing matter, as recent research shows many users are exposing to the Internet the web-based administrative interface for their OpenClaw installations.

Jamieson O’Reilly is a professional penetration tester and founder of the security firm DVULN. In a recent story posted to Twitter/X, O’Reilly warned that exposing a mis-configured OpenClaw web interface to the Internet allows external parties to read the bot’s complete configuration file, including every credential the agent uses — from API keys and bot tokens to OAuth secrets and signing keys.

With that access, O’Reilly said, an attacker could impersonate the operator to their contacts, inject messages into ongoing conversations, and exfiltrate data through the agent’s existing integrations in a way that looks like normal traffic.

“You can pull the full conversation history across every integrated platform, meaning months of private messages and file attachments, everything the agent has seen,” O’Reilly said, noting that a cursory search revealed hundreds of such servers exposed online. “And because you control the agent’s perception layer, you can manipulate what the human sees. Filter out certain messages. Modify responses before they’re displayed.”

O’Reilly documented another experiment that demonstrated how easy it is to create a successful supply chain attack through ClawHub, which serves as a public repository of downloadable “skills” that allow OpenClaw to integrate with and control other applications.

WHEN AI INSTALLS AI

One of the core tenets of securing AI agents involves carefully isolating them so that the operator can fully control who and what gets to talk to their AI assistant. This is critical thanks to the tendency for AI systems to fall for “prompt injection” attacks, sneakily-crafted natural language instructions that trick the system into disregarding its own security safeguards. In essence, machines social engineering other machines.

A recent supply chain attack targeting an AI coding assistant called Cline began with one such prompt injection attack, resulting in thousands of systems having a rogue instance of OpenClaw with full system access installed on their device without consent.

According to the security firm grith.ai, Cline had deployed an AI-powered issue triage workflow using a GitHub action that runs a Claude coding session when triggered by specific

These Bose Quiet Comfort Ultra Earbuds Are 40% Off During Amazon's Big Spring Sale

Daniel Oropenza · Lifehacker

We may earn a commission from links on this page. Deal pricing and availability subject to change after time of publication.

Tech brands love to tout their active noise canceling (ANC) earbuds, but none have reached the standard set by the Bose QuietComfort series. For my money, Bose makes the best ANC gear, and the Bose QuietComfort Ultra (2nd Gen) are the best ANC earbuds you can buy right now.

The downside of Bose buds is that they're pretty pricey, but you no longer need to spend \$300 to get great ANC—not during Amazon's Big Spring Sale. The fantastic first-generation Bose QuietComfort Ultra earbuds in the Moonstone Blue color are going for \$179.99 (originally \$299) on Amazon, the lowest price they've ever reached, according to price-tracking tools.

Brand: Bose, Color: Moonstone Blue, Ear Placement: In Ear, Noise Control: Active Noise Cancellation

Bose QuietComfort Ultra Wireless Earbuds

\$179.00 at Amazon

\$299.00 Save \$120.00

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Though they're an older model, the first-gen Bose QuietComfort Ultra Bluetooth earbuds are still an excellent choice. They received an "outstanding" review from PCMag, not just for their best-in-class ANC, but for their great audio quality in general, Spatial audio support, and diverse codec Bluetooth support with AAC and AptX, which makes them great for Android and Apple users alike. However, they're not perfect: They lack multipoint connectivity, which other high-end earbuds at this price point offer, and there is no wireless charging for the case (if you care about that).

The features are what really set these earbuds apart. They have a CustomTune feature that measures your ear canal's shape to tune the sound and establish your best ANC profile. (You can make your own tweaks in the companion app as well.) Bose's "Immersive Audio" feature allows you to hear your surroundings similarly to how you would when wearing open-ear headphones. You can also mess around with the settings to mix and match outside noise and ANC within the Immersive Audio setting on the app.

You'll get about four to six hours of battery life from the buds and another 12 to 18 with the charging case. The earbuds aren't waterproof, but they are water resistant with

an IPX4 rating, so you can wear them to the gym without worrying about how much you'll sweat.

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Some of My Favorite Milwaukee Tools Come With a Free Battery Right Now

Becca Lewis · Lifehacker

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One of the most expensive parts of a personal tool kit is the batteries, especially if you want to use multiple tools simultaneously without having to swap the battery each time you change tools. Moving seamlessly between drilling pilot holes and driving screws can save you time on your DIY projects, but the cost of extra batteries can add up. These deals from Home Depot are a good way to save more than 50% on a battery and tool combo if you want to expand your Milwaukee set.

Battery combo

18-volt Milwaukee six-amp-hour battery two-pack

Free extra battery with purchase

\$299.00 at Home Depot

\$439.00 Save \$140.00

\$299.00 at Home Depot

\$439.00 Save \$140.00

If you use bigger Milwaukee 18-volt tools like a circular saw, or use a Milwaukee inverter in your emergency kit for temporary emergency power, a few extra six-amp-hour batteries are helpful to have around, but the higher capacity batteries can be expensive. The two-pack of 18-volt Milwaukee six-amp-hour batteries is on sale for \$299, 32% off its regular price. When you open the link to the two-pack, you'll see a "free gift with purchase" menu to the right, and you can select a third six-amp-hour battery from this menu. Once you add the battery, the discount is applied in your cart for a total savings of 53% off.

Tool combos

I use my Milwaukee 18-volt random orbital sander daily when I'm working on furniture and other projects. Having a cordless sander is more convenient because you don't have to drag the cord around when you're working on delicate projects and you can bring it with you wherever you want to work, making it perfect for outdoor woodworking as well. The Milwaukee 18-volt random orbital sander is on sale for \$229 and it comes with a free six-amp-hour 18-volt battery when you select it in the "free gift with purchase" menu, saving you about 46% on the bundle. On this bundle, as with the other two tool bundles, you'll need an 18-volt Milwaukee charger to use the battery.

My Milwaukee oscillating multitool has saved many of my household projects because of its versatility. I used mine when I needed to replace the drain in my 115-year-old

Craftsman's bathroom sink to cut through the plaster and lathe, to cut some PVC components, to trim the drain pipe where it came out from the wall, to trim a patch I installed, and to sand over some places after I patched the wall. The 18-volt Milwaukee oscillating multitool is \$249, and right now, it comes with a free 18-volt, six-amp-hour battery when you select it in the "free gift with purchase" menu, saving you around 44% on the set.

18-volt Milwaukee oscillating multitool

Free battery with purchase

\$249.00 at Home Depot

\$249.00 at Home Depot

I use my 6 ½" Milwaukee circular saw frequently to make quick rip cuts or in places I can't use a table saw. Battery technology has come a long way since I first started using a cordless circular saw and I had to change out my battery every 20 minutes or so. With larger capacity batteries, you can use your cordless circular saw for several hours before needing to replace the battery, depending on the thickness and density of the material you're cutting. The Milwaukee 18-volt, 6 ½" cordless circular saw is \$229, and it comes with a free six-amp-hour battery when you select it in the "free gift with purchase" menu, saving you about 46% on the combo.

Our Best Editor-Vetted Amazon Big Spring Sale Deals Right Now

Apple AirPods Pro 3 Noise Cancelling Heart Rate Wireless Earbuds

— \$199.00

(List Price \$249.00)

Apple iPad 11" 128GB A16 WiFi Tablet (Blue, 2025)

— \$299.00

(List Price \$349.00)

Samsung Galaxy Tab A11+ 128GB Wi-Fi 11" Tablet (Gray)

— \$209.99

(List Price \$249.99)

Sony WH1000XM6- Best Wireless Noise Canceling Headphones

— \$398.00

(List Price \$459.99)

Apple Watch Series 11 (GPS, 42mm, S/M Black Sport Band)

— \$299.00

(List Price \$399.00)

Barbarella Finds MATERIALISTS Pointless

Barbarella · Ain't It Cool News

Barbarella Finds MATERIALISTS Pointless

Read the full article on AICN

Hey friends, Barbarella here to tell you how completely disappointing Materialists is. How can a movie where Pedro Pascal and Chris Evans vie for the affections of a matchmaker fail so badly? Well, let me tell you.

For starters, the chemistry between Dakota Johnson and either romantic rival doesn't quite feel like it's intense enough, so perhaps the casting has some impact, but I don't think that's the issue. I think the script deserves the blame. Don't get me wrong. The story includes lots of laughable moments around dating expectations and so forth. However, one expects characters to evolve throughout a story, to learn lessons, gain deeper understanding or just grow into better people through interactions with others or situations in which they find themselves. None of this happens. So much of the story just makes no sense.

For instance, we are led to believe that Lucy, who's been a top matchmaker for quite some time, never knew that people in real life are sometimes different than they appear on paper. She only learns this when an incident occurs with one of the couples she matches. I mean, anyone who's ever been on a dating site or watched a True Crime story should know that people can portray themselves as some-

thing that they're not. Technically, she apparently does already know people lie on the questionnaire because she comments about guys lying about their height.

For her to apparently have this "revelation" that makes her reevaluate her priorities simply doesn't track. While that bothers me

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Barbarella Adores THE LIFE OF CHUCK

Barbarella · Ain't It Cool News

Barbarella Adores THE LIFE OF CHUCK

Read the full article on AICN

Hey friends, Barbarella here. Have I ever told you what a huge Stephen King fan I am? It started when a teenage me read Pet Sematary and became so enthralled with the author's work that my mom's Christmas shopping became immensely easier. She started gifting me Stephen King books for every Christmas and birthday thereafter, knowing I would eagerly devour every page. I did, with relish. Eventually, I began working my way through movies based on his works. Some ventured from the source material in ways I didn't appreciate, but when I heard Mike Flanagan would be tackling one of King's short stories, The Life of Chuck, I knew I'd love it. And I did.

Mike Flanagan, who's responsible for my favorite horror miniseries, The Haunting of Hill House, and who was the mastermind who brought Doctor Sleep to screens, remains incredibly faithful to the source material, including how it's told in three acts using reverse chronology. It's a film that offers a feast of reflection on life, but I suspect some will dig in more ravenously than others. This is a story about those magical moments in life, the influence others have on our lives, and the decisions we make day to day that steer us one way or another.

Narrated by Nick Offerman, the film begins ominously enough, with the world seemingly coming to an end. Natural and unnatural disasters plague the planet, and as if that's not bad enough, the internet also appears to be out, possibly for good this time. Uncertainty and fear weigh

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She only learns this when an incident occurs with one of the couples she matches.

Barbarella

Damon and Baby review: hellishly fun new Metroidvania shooter

Austin Manchester · Polygon

Damon's tasked with watching over the child at the behest of her caregiver, a priest who died before the events of the game and asked Damon to protect her. He's now stuck with her — quite literally as he'll teleport to wherever he chucks her. (Throwing the baby for traversing levels and dodging attacks in combat is an important part of Damon and Baby's gameplay.) Watching over her side-tracks Damon from moving on up from a Demon King to a Super Demon King. Don't be impressed by those titles, though — in an early display of the game's humor, a pyramid pops up showing that that vaunted Demon King Damon is actually at the lowest level of demon hierarchy.

Amazon Big Spring Sale 2026 Live Blog: All the Best Deals From Apple, Kindle, Garmin, and More

Daniel Oropeza · Lifehacker

We may earn a commission from links on this page. Deal pricing and availability subject to change after time of publication.

Early deals from Amazon's Big Spring Sale were surprisingly good, and starting today, Wednesday, March 25, the sale is now in full swing. As is the case with other big Amazon sales, I'm going to highlight all the best deals as our team covers them throughout the event. All of our recommended deals have been vetted using price-tracking tools, so you can trust that the sales we're talking about are actually good deals, and not just hype designed to fool you.

You can read more details about the spring sale here, like what to expect, how long it'll last, and some tips to make your shopping experience better. You can also just browse what's on sale here on your own. We'll continue highlighting new deals as we find them, but you can scroll through to see earlier deals that may still be active.

NYCC 2025 Exclusive! David Dastmalchian Talks Mental Wellness and Pushing ‘Through’

McEric · Ain't It Cool News

Eric McClanahan sits down with multi-hyphenate creator David Dastmalchian at New York City Comic Con to discuss his new Graphic Novel ‘Through’ and his forthcoming directorial debut.

Read the full article on AICN

Some interview opportunities aren’t a hard sell at all. Such is the case when I was offered the opportunity to sit down with one of today’s most prolific and impactful actors, David Dastmalchian. David exploded onto screens in 2008’s THE DARK KNIGHT as a haunted paranoid schizophrenic in the employ of Heath Ledger’s Joker. Thanks to his dangerous eyes and lean face, he’s found steady work in television and film as villains, victims, and various tortured characters. He’s worked in both the DC and Marvel Universes onscreen as well as extensive voice-work. He was a welcome addition to this year’s “Dexter: Resurrection” and will next be seen as Big Bad M. Bison in the newest live-action adaptation of the classic video game STREET FIGHTER.

Even those who don’t know (or can’t pronounce) his name know his face from his extensive character work, but many may not know that he’s also a gifted and prolific writer. His ‘Count Crowley’ series was a big hit for Dark Horse Comics and he’s written acclaimed titles for Marvel, DC, and Image.

His newest graphic novel, coming next year from Z2 comics, promises to be his most personal story to date: ‘Through.’

“From the mind of David Dastmalchian (Late Night with the Devil, Suicide Squad), Alix is a young woman, orphaned as a child, and isolated by perfectionism as an adult, who falls into an enchanted realm. A secret place created to serve as her sanctuary. It’s a realm under siege, transformed into a perilous land of

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A Conversation with RENTAL FAMILY Writer/Director HIKARI

McEric · Ain't It Cool News

McEric chats with RENTAL FAMILY writer/director HIKARI.

Read the full article on AICN

HIKARI’s RENTAL FAMILY is the feel-good charmer that everyone needs around Thanksgiving, a gentle reminder that family is organic, genuine, and irreplaceable. Even when we sometimes wish we could rent an understudy to fill our place.

RENTAL FAMILY stars Brendan Fraser as Phillip, an American actor living alone in Japan for the past seven years, struggling to find consistent work. Think LOST IN TRANSLATION, only don’t, because this film provides a much deeper portrait of Japan than Sofia Coppola’s Oscar-winner. LOST IN TRANSLATION, though a beautiful portrait of loneliness, uses Japan as a superficial location, giving us the eyes of a visitor through which to take in its beauty. RENTAL FAMILY has an expatriate at its center but Phillip has taken swimmingly to his new home. He’s fluent, versed in the customs, and permanent. One never gets the idea that Phillip is working towards returning “home” - he is home. With him as our anchor, we feel like we belong, seeing past the tourist attractions to find the core of community.

Phillip is auditioning steadily, getting bit roles here and there, but he needs something with longevity. He stumbles into Rental Family, a service

that sells “memories.” Mastermind Tada (Takehiro Hira) is introduced as a compassionate man with a fierce streak of pragmatism, which is aided by his right hand and lead actress Aiko (Mari Yamamoto). Brought on board as their “token white guy,” Phillip finds himself acting as a groom, a best friend, a karaoke champion, a journalist, and a long-lost

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TRAUMATIKA Interview with filmmakers Pierre Tsigaridis and Maxime Rancon

McEric · Ain't It Cool News

Eric McClanahan speaks with TRAUMATIKA filmmakers Pierre Tsigaridis and Maxime Rancon

Read the full article on AICN

Horror films are a mixed bag - some make an indelible mark on the landscape while others are here and gone before anyone has made an effort to notice. A good idea, great execution, and ambitious marketing allow many to rise above the din and grab audiences by the throat. Such is the case with TRAUMATIKA.

Online trailers warn that "This is not a movie you see, it's a movie you survive." Having seen this film, I would agree to a certain extent. TRAUMATIKA does a lot of things right, but I have a few insignificant gripes with it, as well. Let's start with its strengths.

TRAUMATIKA builds tension by the inches. Slow POV camerawork, complete with blinking, puts the audience in the front seat of fear. The film is impeccably shot with long, sustained instances of hair-raising suspense and explosive scenes of violence and terror. It's a visceral experience that will delight many hardcore horror fans and certainly marks the emergence of brash new voices in horror.

My main grievance is with the scope of the film. It's several stories crammed into one, and I got the idea that it might've worked better as an anthology than a single narrative. The film

begins in 1910, then 2003, then a year prior, then 20 years later. So much horror and terror are unleashed throughout time but through such disparate antagonists that one is left to wonder which movie to refer to when honing in on a particular victory or loss.

TRAUMATIKA comes to us

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GOOD LUCK, HAVE FUN, DON'T DIE Proves Bonkers!

Barbarella · Ain't It Cool News

GOOD LUCK, HAVE FUN, DON'T DIE Proves Bonkers!

Read the full article on AICN

Hey friends! Barbarella here. If you're looking for a film that delivers energy, wit, and a whole lot of crazy, look no further than GOOD LUCK, HAVE FUN, DON'T DIE! It takes viewers on a wacky journey through the follies of modern society, wrapping its social commentary in humor and action. In theaters Friday, February 13, this movie starts strong as it introduces its ensemble of motley characters. When a man (Sam Rockwell) comes back from the future to recruit a band of misfits to help save the world, he heads straight to Norm's, a diner in Los Angeles.

From the moment he enters, Sam Rockwell commands the screen with an opening exposition that could easily have felt weighty if it weren't for his entertaining and animated way of presenting the information. Keeping the scene dynamic despite the extensive dialogue proves one of the many smart choices director Gore Verbinski (Pirates of the Caribbean, The Ring, Rango) makes throughout the film. The director taped out the entire diner in a rehearsal space where he worked extensively with Sam Rockwell on the path he would take and where people and things needed to be for him to hit the marks and keep everything flowing. He then sent the layout to the production designer

to build the set to fit the specifics of the performance.

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Sucker Punch is peak Zack Snyder, for better or worse

Jesse Hassenger · Polygon

There may be Zack Snyder movies more notorious than Sucker Punch — particularly those that pertain to Batman and/or Superman and/or their mothers' shared first name — but no Snyder movie has bombed harder at the box office than his action-fantasy-psychodrama. (Yes, even the one about warring owls did better.) Perhaps not coincidentally, Sucker Punch, which takes place simultaneously in a corrupt mental institution, a gangster-run brothel, and an impossibly vast fantasy battle-scape, is also the only Snyder movie not based on pre-existing materials to receive a wide theatrical release. Its flop was a sign that, for as much mainstream success and cult adoration as the filmmaker has enjoyed on various projects, there are limits to his fandom, and maybe also his imagination.

Barbarella Chats With Cool Peeps from EDIE ARNOLD IS A LOSER

Barbarella · Ain't It Cool News

Barbarella Chats With Cool Peeps from EDIE ARNOLD IS A LOSER

Read the full article on AICN

Hey friends. Barbarella here, coming at you from deep in the heart of Texas. That's right. It's spring, and I've been SXSWing hard this year. One of the films making a splash here is EDIE ARNOLD IS A LOSER. This high energy comedy about Catholic school girls who form a punk band only has one more screening at this fest.

I took a break from the movies, music, and mayhem to sit down with the the film's directors Kade Atwood and Megan Rico (who also wrote it) and actors Adi Madden Cabrera (Edie) and McKenna Tuckett (Francis). Check out our conversation!

Barbara: I'm going to start with the Catholic school question, because when I was a kid, my dad was in the military, and we moved around a lot. We lived in El Paso for a couple years, and he didn't want us in public schools there so they sent us to Catholic school. We're not Catholic, so it was a weird thing because we were not allowed to do the religious stuff. We were really outcast. It was a very uncomfortable, bizarre experience. I would like to know, what is your experience with Catholic schools?

Megan: I went to an all-girls Catholic school in Miami, Florida so a lot of stuff from the script is pulled

pretty directly from that experience. It is a weird experience. I feel like as an outsider, you probably noticed it even more. It's a lot of arbitrary rigidity. It was like, why are we putting so much emphasis

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THE DAILY SHOW writer Daniel Radosh and editor Lauren Beckett Jackson Interview

McEric · Ain't It Cool News

McEric sits down with THE DAILY SHOW writer Daniel Radosh and editor Lauren Beckett Jackson for an interview

Read the full article on AICN

Comedy Central's "The Daily Show" has been on-air for almost thirty years, garnering 26 PrimeTime Emmy Awards and several Peabody Awards for its writing and execution. Many are familiar with the show's blend of current news commentary and informational journalism from comedians like Jon Stewart, Stephen Colbert, Steve Carrell, John Oliver, Samatha Bee, Roy Wood, Jr, Rob Riggle, Jordan Klepper, Wyatt Cenac, Hasan Minhaj, Larry Whitmore, Lewis Black, Desi Lydic, Ronny Chieng, Michael Kosta, and a bevy of others. "The Daily Show's" audience has grown up alongside the show, with viewership now skewing in higher age demographics than the coveted 18-34 bracket it dominated during its inception. That maturity is reflected in the current iteration of the show, with Stewart hosting on Monday's while the rest of "The Best F**king News Team" fill in the remainder of the week.

"The Daily Show" is a bit of a misnomer as the show broadcasts nightly on Comedy Central (or Paramount+ for those living in the streaming age) from Monday to Thursday. I suppose "The Intermittent Show" just doesn't have the same ring to it. "The Daily Show" is not unique in its position

as a satirical news program, however it remains the definitive iteration of the format. Everyone knows about "The Daily Show," love it or hate it. A foundational pillar of the show's ubiquity and popularity is in the writing and execution of the show, which stands head and shoulders above its contemporaries.

I was honored to speak with senior writer Daniel Radosh

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Scott Adkins Talks DIABLO

McEric · Ain't It Cool News

Scott Adkins talks with McEric about his new action film, DIABLO

Read the full article on AICN

If you're a fan of current action films then you likely know the name Scott Adkins. He's either kicked the ass of or had his ass kicked by every action star of the last five decades: Dolph Lundgren, Jackie Chan, Sylvester Stallone, Jean Claude Van Damme, Jet Li, and even Keanu Reeves. That's right - he was the big guy with the grill in JOHN WICK CHAPTER 4.

Scott's newest film is DIABLO, which hits theaters and on demand this Friday, June 13th. Conceived alongside action compatriot Marko Zaror, the film takes place in Colombia following Adkins as Kris, a former convict, who seeks to make good on a promise to a fallen friend, which runs him afoul of Zaror's mercenary, El Corvo. This film isn't just another straight-to-streaming no-budget piece of content - DIABLO delivers on every front. The fight scenes, choreographed by Zaror, are intense and deftly photographed, thanks to director Ernesto Diaz Espinoza. The gunplay is intense, the acting is top tier, and the film never lags.

Marko Zaror steals his scenes as El Corvo, a mercenary with an iron fist, literally. The six-foot-two Chilean action star has a chilling villain introduction, followed by a massive action scene in a sketchy hideout that plays out like

a scene from TERMINATOR. He mows through assailants and bystanders alike with no emotion, only showing a hint of fear when Adkins's Kris shows up to give him a real fight. El Corvo is fucking terrifying. Their final confrontation is a throwback to

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“The Daily Show” is not unique in its position as a satirical news program, however it remains the definitive iteration of the format.

McEric

ANALYSIS

IN BRIEF

Laura Harold, Yoga Journal: Yoga slowly revealed my true nature, which has nothing to do with how much I accomplish.

The post [As an Overachiever, I Didn't Think I'd Like Yoga. I Was Wrong.](#) appeared first on [Yoga Journal](#).

Bruno Couriol, InfoQ: Max Inden recently explored in a talk at FOSDEM 2026 how the upcoming WebTransport protocol and Web API enhance WebSocket capabilities. WebTransport seeks to provide, among other things, lower latency and transparent network switching for key use cases such as high-frequency financial data streaming, cloud gaming, live streaming, and collaborative editing.

By Bruno Couriol

ZDNet, ZDNet: Spring has sprung, and an Amazon Big Spring Sale is officially here. Here are the best headphone deals to shop.

Tomas Franzese, Polygon: Crimson Desert Patch 1.01 rolled out on PC, PS5, and Xbox Series X|S on Saturday and is the most substantial update the vast action-adventure game has seen yet. In addition to adding five brand-new mounts for players to summon and ride around Pywel, it makes control and quality-of-life tweaks to Crimson Desert and begins the process of removing the game's AI-generated art.

Samantha Nelson, Polygon: Drew Goddard wrote the screenplays for Ridley Scott's 2015 film *The Martian* and Phil Lord and Christopher Miller's *Project Hail Mary*, both based on Andy Weir novels about astronauts using all their ingenuity to survive in space. Goddard captures Weir's mix of complex science and goofy humor in highly faithful and captivating adaptations, but he also cuts one of Weir's weirdest recurring gags from both books: cannibalism humor.

Calin Van Paris, Yoga Journal: Only you can know what your body needs.

The post [This Is My Favorite Cue in All of Yoga. Here's How It Can Support Your Practice.](#) appeared first on [Yoga Journal](#).

Yun Liu, The Keyword (Google Blog): The winners of the MedGemma Impact Challenge demonstrated the potential of Google's open medical models for solving diverse healthcare challenges.

ZDNet, ZDNet: Google Maps can help plan your entire trip for you and beyond if you're hip to all these time-saving shortcuts.

ZDNet, ZDNet: The Samsung Galaxy Buds 4 Pro are a solid upgrade over the Buds 3 Pro. But you should still know what you're getting before picking the newer pair.

Steef-Jan Wiggers, InfoQ: Discord engineering detailed how they added distributed tracing to Elixir's actor model. Their custom Transport library wraps messages with trace context and uses dynamic sampling to handle million-user fanouts. CPU optimizations included skipping unsampled traces and filtering context before deserialization, recovering 10+ percentage points of overhead.

By Steef-Jan Wiggers

ZDNet, ZDNet: We found deals on tablets up to \$150 off from brands like Apple, Samsung, and more, for Amazon's Big Spring Sale this week. Sales are live now through March 31.

This is Google's “affordable” phone, which means there are some compromises here over the main Pixel line.

Jake Peterson

The Examiner

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